Application & Interview Prep Checklist

Companion to the Master Checklist (tech skills) and DSA_Master_Checklist (CP/DSA). This one covers the application-facing side of placement prep: profile, resume, core CS/HR, explaining your work, communication, aptitude, and the application process itself.

Section 1: Professional Profile Optimization

LinkedIn

- [ ] Update with summer vacation work (Shard/Cairn, Conclave, Foundry, etc.)
- [ ] Headline — role-targeted, not just “Student at GNIOT”
- [ ] About section rewritten
- [ ] Experience entries synced with resume
- [ ] Featured section — link 2–3 strongest repos/demos
- [ ] Start a regular posting cadence (build-in-public style: milestones, learnings)

GitHub

- [ ] Update pinned repos + profile README with summer work
- [ ] Add a short description to every repo (one-liner under repo name, not the README)
- [ ] Every pinned repo has a real README (problem, tech stack, screenshots/demo link)
- [ ] Regular commit cadence, not just at deadlines

Portfolio + Blog Site (mirrors LinkedIn structure)

- [ ] Rebuild locally on own stack (own repo, own domain, full control — moving off AI Studio)
- [ ] Home / Headline
- [ ] About
- [ ] Experience (IBM-PBEL, synced with LinkedIn/resume)
- [ ] Featured Projects
- [ ] Skills
- [ ] Blog (replaces LinkedIn's post feed — project writeups, learnings)
- [ ] Deploy + connect domain

Other Platforms

- [ ] Explore X and Bluesky — decide if active or just claimed
- [ ] Job portals updated (per existing portal doc)
- [ ] Freelance site profile set up (for fun/side income, lower priority)

Section 2: Resume Creation

- [ ] Master content doc — all project bullets, experience, etc. in one place; grammatically clean, doesn't read as AI-generated
- [ ] Base resumes per track — pre-built versions per resume track (Java Backend, Python Backend, AI Engineer, etc.) with that track's assigned projects already slotted in
- [ ] Bullet library per project (2–3 variants each) for fast tailoring

[ ] Tailoring pass before each application — fine-tune relevant base resume, then update LinkedIn/GitHub/portfolio simultaneously

[ ] ATS-safe formatting — no tables, text boxes, or graphics that break parsing

[ ] Standard, parseable fonts

[ ] One page — hard limit, regardless of how many projects exist in the master doc

[ ] PDF export tested through an ATS checker/parser

Note: Master content doc = source repository (unlimited length). Every applied resume stays one page, assembled by selecting from the repository per job description.

Section 3: Core CS / HR Interview Prep

Operating Systems

[ ] Process vs Thread, process states, context switching

[ ] CPU Scheduling (FCFS, SJF, Round Robin, Priority)

[ ] Deadlock (conditions, prevention, avoidance)

[ ] Memory Management (paging, segmentation, virtual memory, thrashing)

[ ] Synchronization (semaphores, mutex, producer-consumer)

Computer Networks

[ ] OSI vs TCP/IP model

[ ] TCP vs UDP

[ ] HTTP/HTTPS, DNS, how a URL resolves end-to-end

[ ] IP addressing basics

Cross-referenced (already covered in Master Checklist)

[ ] DBMS — Phase 5

[ ] OOP — Phase 2

HR & Resume-Based

[ ] Classic HR questions (strengths/weaknesses, why this company, where do you see yourself, why should we hire you)

[ ] Resume-based Q&A; — prep an answer for every bullet on the resume

Note: Kept at fresher-interview conceptual depth, not full GATE computational depth.

Section 4: Explaining Your Work

[ ] Convert existing project docs (README/roadmap/learning docs) into a spoken narrative — practice explaining out loud from what's already written

[ ] Per project: why this decision over the alternative, what you'd change at scale, one real debugging story

[ ] IBM-PBEL — same structure, framed around specific contribution vs team's

[ ] Test live — explain a project to someone unscripted, note what was confusing

Section 5: Communication (soft skills only)

- [ ] Spoken English practice — daily short-form (read aloud, shadow a podcast/talk, record yourself)
- [ ] Mock interviews — with a friend or on a platform, not just self-rehearsal
- [ ] Group discussion practice, if placement drives include GDs
- [ ] Answering under pressure — practice thinking out loud instead of long silent pauses
- [ ] Feedback loop — record yourself or get a friend's honest read after each mock

Section 6: Aptitude Prep

- [ ] One timed mock test to confirm baseline
- [ ] Brush up weak areas only, based on that mock
- [ ] No dedicated heavy prep block — light-touch section given existing college aptitude classes

Section 7: Application Process (final step)

4 Priority Channels

- [ ] Cold mail — direct outreach to companies/recruiters
- [ ] Job portals — Naukri, Internshala, LinkedIn Jobs, etc.
- [ ] Company career pages — applying directly
- [ ] On-campus drives — through college placement cell

Tracking (via Trajectory)

- [ ] Log every application: company, role, channel, track/resume variant used, date, status
- [ ] Track which base resume + featured project was sent per application